

NORTHFIELD & VALE RETAIL GROUP

Quarterly Customer Complaint Summary

Product Line: Apparel & Footwear | Quarter: Q3 2024 (Jul-Sep) | Prepared by: Customer

Experience Analytics Team | Date Issued: October 9, 2024

1. SUMMARY

The Apparel & Footwear product line logged 226 complaints in Q3 2024, up 14% from Q2 2024 (198 complaints). The increase coincides with the Fall Collection launch in early August and a higher-than-average return rate on the StrideLine running shoe.

2. COMPLAINT VOLUME BY CATEGORY

- Sizing inconsistency: 88 complaints (39%)
- Product defect (stitching, zippers, soles): 66 complaints (29%)
- Color/material mismatch from listing photos: 34 complaints (15%)
- Difficulty with returns/refund processing: 26 complaints (12%)
- Shipping damage: 12 complaints (5%)

3. TOP PRODUCTS BY COMPLAINT COUNT

1. StrideLine Trail Running Shoe - 54 complaints. Most common issue: sizing runs approximately half a size small compared to prior seasons. 2. UrbanFlex Denim Jacket - 39 complaints. Most common issue: stitching along the sleeve seam unraveling within the first month. 3. CozyKnit Wool Sweater - 31 complaints. Most common issue: color noticeably lighter than the product photo (reported most for the "Charcoal" variant). 4. TrailBlazer Rain Shell - 27 complaints. Most common issue: zipper pull detaching after moderate use. 5. FlexFit Performance Leggings - 21 complaints. Most common issue: waistband elastic losing shape after fewer than 10 washes.

4. REGIONAL BREAKDOWN

West region stores accounted for 30% of complaints, followed by Northeast (26%), South (24%), and Midwest (20%). The West's higher share aligns with above-average StrideLine sell-through in that region during the back-to-school season.

5. RESOLUTION METRICS

- Average time to resolution: 3.1 days (target: 5 days)
- Complaints resolved via exchange (different size): 44%
- Complaints resolved via refund: 33%
- Complaints resolved via store credit: 23%
- Customer satisfaction score post-resolution (CSAT): 3.9 / 5.0

6. ROOT CAUSE NOTES

The StrideLine sizing issue has been confirmed as a last-adjustment change made by the manufacturer for the Fall 2024 production run without corresponding updates to the size chart on the product listing. Category Management has requested an updated size chart be published immediately. The UrbanFlex stitching issue is under review with the garment manufacturer's quality team; early findings point to a thread-tension calibration issue on one production line.

7. RECOMMENDATIONS

- Publish corrected StrideLine size chart across all channels within 2 weeks and add an on-page sizing advisory.
- Request manufacturer QA report on UrbanFlex stitching defect by end of October.
- Update CozyKnit product photography under consistent lighting conditions for accurate color representation.
- Monitor FlexFit leggings return rate through Q4 to determine if a material change is warranted.

This report is confidential and intended for internal distribution to Category Management, Engineering, and Executive Leadership only.